SEO Changelog: What Is Crab Island in Destin, Florida?

URL: https://crabislandtikitoursdestin.com/about-crab-island/what-is-crab-island-destin/ | WP page ID 786 (block content) | Last modified July 27, 2026 | Audit date: October 28, 2026 | Page 7 of the site queue

Method: content, headings, links, images and SEO meta were pulled from WordPress through the site connector. The live URL could not be loaded from the audit environment.

1. Summary

Item	Current state
Role	Answers the top informational query "what is crab island". High search volume, and the page most likely to be cited by AI answers.
SEO title	What Is Crab Island in Destin, Florida? Full Guide (50 characters, good)
Meta description	145 characters, but ends with "from $900", a disputed price.
H1	What Is Crab Island in Destin, Florida? (good, matches the query)
Body copy	About 1,900 words. Strong quick answer. Two sections repeat each other, and a few claims are stated as fact without support.
Internal links	Only 2 links inside the body (both in the final CTA, one broken). The other 9 are in the footer list, including a link to this page itself.
Images	2 images: a 400×400 thumbnail and the same 2048×768 PNG infographic used on the hub page.

2. Sitewide template issues (fix once, applies to all 8 guide pages)

The eight /about-crab-island/ pages were built from one template in July 2026. Pages 6 and 7 share the same problems, so the remaining guides almost certainly do too. Fixing them in bulk saves time:

#	Issue	Bulk fix
A	P1 Broken charter link	Run a site-wide search and replace: `/charters/private-crab-island-pontoon-destin/` to `/charters/private-crab-island-charter-destin/`, and `/charters/sunset-cruise/` to `/charters/private-sunset-cruise-in-destin-fl/`. Also add 301s for both old paths.
B	P1 "$900" price	Once the real price is confirmed, search and replace "$900" in the guides and their meta descriptions. Better: remove prices from guide meta descriptions so they don't go stale.
C	P1 Plain-text phone	Replace "850-613-1966" with a `tel:+18506131966` link everywhere.

D	P2 Self-link in footer list	Turn the "More Crab Island Questions Answered" list into a reusable block (WordPress synced pattern) and remove the current page from it on each guide, or style the current page as plain text.
E	P2 FAQ not marked up	Convert each FAQ section to the Rank Math FAQ block.
F	P2 Same infographic on every page	Convert Crab-Island-Tiki-Boat-Rental.png to WebP once. Consider a page-specific image per guide (map for "where", depth chart for "how deep").
G	P2 No author or date	Add an author line (Captain Bill) and "Updated" date, plus Article schema with author and dateModified.

3. Page-specific fixes

#	Issue	Fix
1	P1 Two sections say the same thing	"What Crab Island Actually Looks Like Today" (morning is quiet, 1 p.m. in July is busiest) and "What a Typical Day Out There Looks Like" (8 a.m. quiet, noon to 4 busiest) cover the same timeline. Merge them into one section and link to the Best Time guide for the full schedule.
2	P1 Claims without support	Soften or source these: "the largest and most popular sandbar hangout on the Emerald Coast"; "Very few places on the Gulf Coast offer that combination"; "ranks among the most family-friendly attractions in Destin"; "Incidents at the sandbar are extremely rare." Suggested rewrites are in section 6.
3	P2 History has no date or source	"Dredging work tied to the Destin East Pass piled up sediment and created a genuine island." Add when it happened and cite a local source (Okaloosa County, the Destin History & Fishing Museum, or a newspaper archive). Specific, sourced history is what gets cited by Google and AI answers.
4	P3 Empty paragraph	A non-breaking-space paragraph sits above the infographic. Delete it.

4. SEO title and meta description

Field	Current	New
SEO title	What Is Crab Island in Destin, Florida? Full Guide	Keep.
Meta description	What is Crab Island in Destin, Florida? A shallow 2 to 4 foot sandbar reached only by boat. History, layout, vendors, and how to visit from $900.	**What is Crab Island in Destin, Florida? A shallow 2 to 4 foot sandbar near the Marler Bridge, reached only by boat. History, vendors and how to visit.** (150 characters)
Focus keyword	Primary: **what is crab island**. Secondary: is crab island a real island, crab island history, crab island sandbar, how big is crab island.	

5. Heading structure

Current

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H1  What Is Crab Island in Destin, Florida?
H2  Key Takeaways
H2  The Short History Behind the Name
H2  What Crab Island Actually Looks Like Today
H2  Why the Water Is So Shallow
H2  What People Do Out There
H2  What a Typical Day Out There Looks Like        (repeats "Looks Like Today")
H2  Rules and Etiquette at the Sandbar
H2  How Crab Island Compares to a Destin Beach Day
H2  Getting There Without Owning a Boat
H2  What Makes Crab Island Worth the Trip
H2  Frequently Asked Questions
  H3  x5
H2  See Crab Island for Yourself
H2  More Crab Island Questions Answered
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New

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H1  What Is Crab Island in Destin, Florida?
H2  Key Takeaways
H2  The History Behind the Name
H2  Crab Island Through the Day                    (merged section)
H2  Why the Water Is So Shallow
H2  What to Do at Crab Island
  H3  Floating Food and Drink Vendors
  H3  Paddleboarding and Kayaking
  H3  Dolphin Watching
  H3  Parties and Celebrations
H2  Crab Island Rules and Etiquette
H2  Crab Island vs a Destin Beach Day
H2  How to Get to Crab Island Without a Boat
H2  Why Crab Island Draws a Crowd
H2  Crab Island FAQs
  H3  x5 existing + 1 new
H2  See Crab Island for Yourself
H2  More Crab Island Questions Answered
```

6. Content rewrites (paste-ready)

H2: Crab Island Through the Day (replaces both "Looks Like" sections)

> Crab Island changes by the hour. Around 8 a.m. the water is glassy, the sand shows clearly through three feet of green, and only a few boats are anchored. From about 10 to noon the rental pontoons and vendor boats arrive and it feels lively without being packed.
>
> Noon to 4 p.m. is the scene you see in photos: hundreds of boats rafted together, music from every direction and paddleboards weaving between hulls. The water gets cloudier from all the movement.

> After 4 or 5, rental boats head back, the light gets better and the crowd thins out. For the best hours by season, see the best time to visit Crab Island.

H2: What to Do at Crab Island (split list into H3s)

> **H3: Floating Food and Drink Vendors**
> Vendor boats sell ice cream, boiled peanuts, tacos and cold drinks in the warm months. Bring cash. See what to bring to Crab Island.
>
> **H3: Paddleboarding and Kayaking**
> The flats are calm enough to paddle between boats. Watch for anchor lines.
>
> **H3: Dolphin Watching**
> Dolphins are often seen in the pass and the bay nearby, especially toward evening. A private sunset cruise is built around that time of day.
>
> **H3: Parties and Celebrations**
> Birthdays, reunions and bachelorette parties raft up at the sandbar all season.

Softened claims

Current	Rewrite
Very few places on the Gulf Coast offer that combination of clear water, sand bottom, and standing depth.	That mix of clear water, a sand bottom and standing depth is hard to find this close to a busy harbor.
Functionally, it is the largest and most popular sandbar hangout on the Emerald Coast...	For many Destin visitors, it's the main reason to get on a boat at all.
Incidents at the sandbar are extremely rare.	Shark encounters at the sandbar are uncommon, and the shallow water and heavy boat traffic tend to keep larger fish away. (Add a source, such as the Florida Museum's International Shark Attack File, if you keep a claim about frequency.)
Yes, and it ranks among the most family-friendly attractions in Destin for exactly that reason.	Yes. Standing-depth water makes it one of the easier places in Destin to bring young kids.

New FAQ

> **Can you walk to Crab Island?** No. There is no bridge, path or beach access. You can only reach it by boat, kayak or paddleboard, and paddling across the channel near the Marler Bridge is risky because of boat traffic and current. See how to get to Crab Island.

7. Internal linking (contextual, inside the body)

Anchor text	Target	Placement
just north of the Marler Bridge	/about-crab-island/where-is-crab-island/	Quick answer

2 to 4 feet	/about-crab-island/how-deep-is-crab-island/	Why the Water Is So Shallow
when the tide turns	/high-tide-vs-low-tide-at-crab-island/	Rules and Etiquette
the best time to visit Crab Island	/about-crab-island/best-time-to-visit-crab-island/	Through the Day
what to bring to Crab Island	/about-crab-island/what-to-bring-to-crab-island/	Vendors H3
private sunset cruise	/charters/private-sunset-cruise-in-destin-fl/	Dolphin H3
bachelorette parties	/crab-island-bachelorette-party-destin/	Parties H3
how to get to Crab Island	/about-crab-island/how-to-get-to-crab-island/	Getting There + new FAQ
Florida boater safety certificate	/about-crab-island/tiki-boat-vs-pontoon-rental-crab-island/	Getting There
what a boat trip costs	/about-crab-island/how-much-does-crab-island-cost/	Getting There
families with young kids	/is-crab-island-family-friendly/	FAQ
private Crab Island charter page	/charters/private-crab-island-charter-destin/	Fix broken CTA link

Inbound: Home and the hub already point here. Ask the "Things to Do in Destin" post to link with anchor "what Crab Island is".

8. Images

File	Current alt	Action
image-9.webp (400×400)	What is Crab Island	Use a wide aerial or boat-level photo of the sandbar, at least 1200 px. Alt: "Boats anchored in shallow green water at Crab Island, Destin". Set as featured image.
Crab-Island-Tiki-Boat-Rental.png	Crab Island Tiki Boat Rental Infographic	WebP (template fix F). On this page, a "morning vs afternoon" photo pair would fit the content better.

9. Technical

#	Item	Action
1	P1 Schema	Article (author, dateModified), FAQPage via Rank Math block, and `about` pointing to the Crab Island TouristAttraction defined on the hub.
2	P2 Competing page on sister site	bikkinibottomboat.com/what-is-crab-island/ targets the same query. Keep both, but make sure the wording isn't shared between them. Consider having one link to the other.

3	P3 Breadcrumbs	Home > About Crab Island > What Is Crab Island.

10. Tracking

Event	Setup
guide_to_booking	In GA4, build a path exploration starting from this page to see how many visitors reach the Charter page or FareHarbor. Informational pages rarely convert directly, so measure assisted conversions.
phone_click / book_now_click	Same as hub, with `page_type=guide` and `guide_name=what_is`.
Search Console	Track "what is crab island" and "is crab island a real island" queries. Compare CTR before and after the meta change.

11. Changelog

#	Area	Change	Priority	Status
1	Links	Site-wide search and replace for the 2 broken charter URLs, plus 301s (template A)	P1	To do
2	Content	Merge the two "day at Crab Island" sections	P1	To do
3	Content	Soften 4 unsupported claims; add date and source to history	P1	To do
4	Meta	Price-free meta description (150 characters)	P1	To do
5	Links	Add 11 contextual body links; fix CTA link; remove footer self-link	P1	To do
6	Links	Phone number to tel: link (template C)	P1	To do
7	Headings	Merged H2, split activities into 4 H3s, shorter H2 wording	P2	To do
8	Content	New FAQ: Can you walk to Crab Island?	P2	To do
9	Technical	Article and FAQPage schema, author line, breadcrumbs (templates E, G)	P2	To do
10	Images	Wide lead photo, featured image, WebP infographic	P2	To do
11	Tracking	Guide-to-booking path report, guide_name parameter	P3	To do